

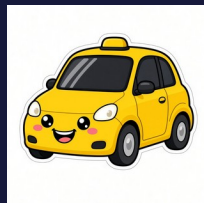
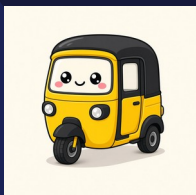
RAPIDO DATA SCIENCE ASSESSMENT

Captain onboarding leak & overnight airport supply

Findings and recommendations for the Head of Supply — where the extra ~180 approved captains a month come from, and why overnight airport supply is an economics problem, not a headcount one.

Ramanathan K R

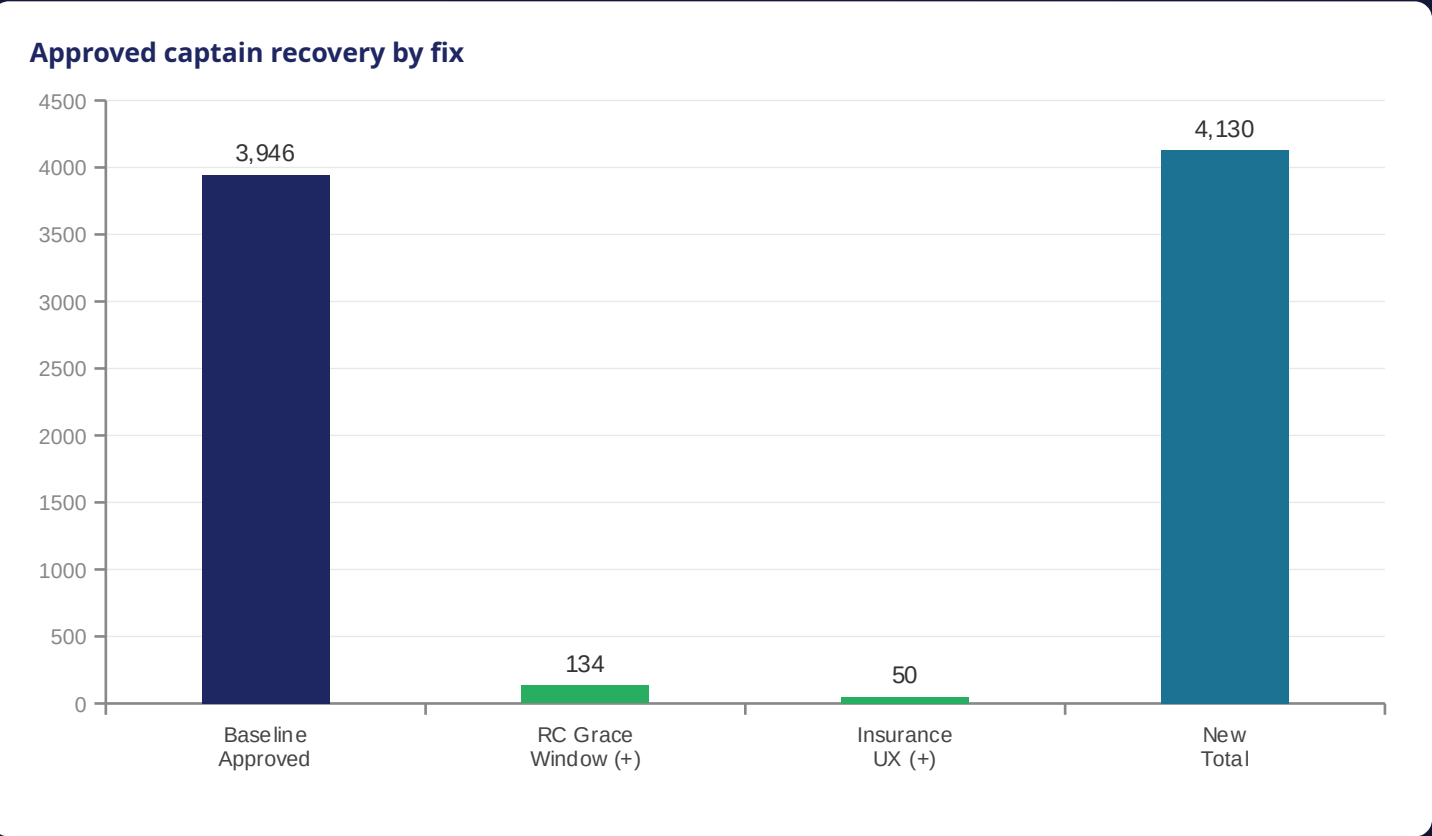
Data Science Assessment · 10 September 2026 · Data extract as of 30 Jun 2026, 23:59 IST



25k signups · RC · Insurance · Airport nights

One broken capture step costs ~180 captains/month.

Two capture-quality fixes on RC and Insurance — not a mix of five things — recover ~180 additional approved captains/month at medium confidence.



98.7%

of mature approved captains take a first trip (3,895 / 3,946) — documents are the bottleneck, not first-order.

~134/mo

Recovered from an RC in-person grace window (C1a)

~50/mo

Recovered from Insurance guided capture UX fix (C1b)

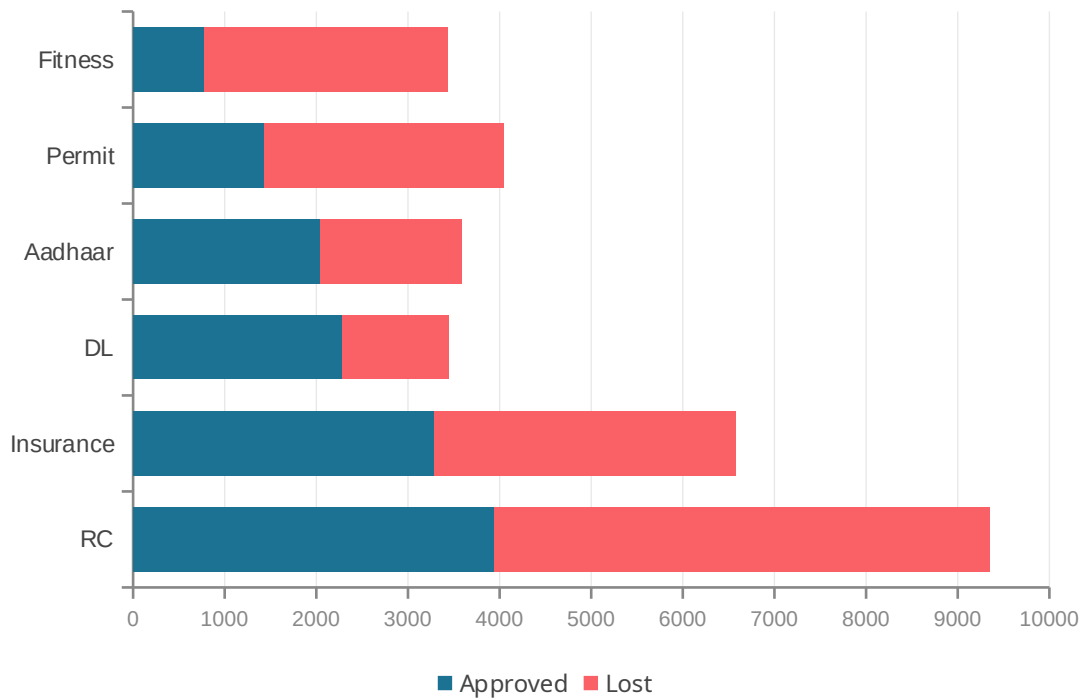


ROOT CAUSE

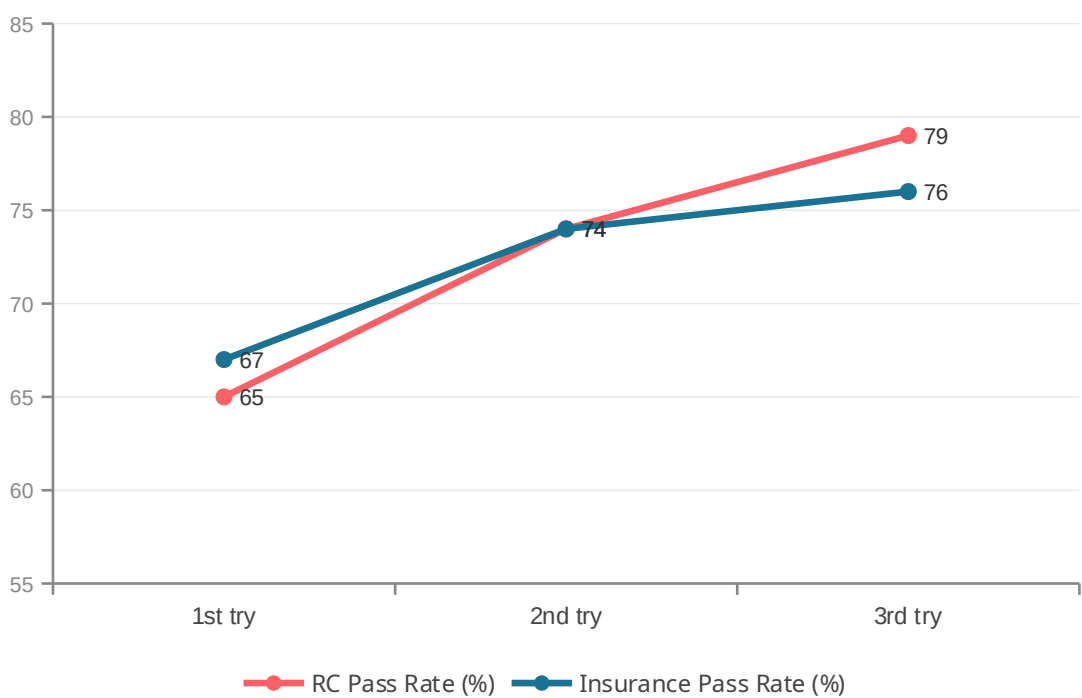
RC and Insurance are failing as photographs, not documents

Capture-class failures (blur, weak OCR, illegibility) dominate RC and Insurance, and later attempts pass MORE often. That is the signature of a capture / UX problem, not an eligibility one.

Funnel: approved vs. lost by document



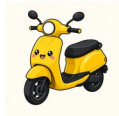
Retry pass rates rise — capture problem, not eligibility



1,637 RC and 411 Insurance captains are capture-only fails — isolated from eligibility reasons (expired, duplicate, wrong type). DL (1,166) is 100% uploaded-fail and cannot be deferred.

One recommendation, two sub-actions — RC defers, Insurance doesn't

C1a — RC



Provisional activation 10-day in-person grace window

Who: 1,637 RC capture-only fails (~300/mo)

Why defer: Vehicle identity — no passenger-liability exposure

Show-up: 40 / 60 / 80% × 74–78% pass rate

Central case: ~134/month additional approved

Needs: Legal + Trust & Safety sign-off on deferral

If remaining docs still bind: $P(\text{approved} \mid \text{passed RC}) = 27\% \rightarrow \sim 36/\text{month}$ (Legal ask)

C1b — Insurance



Guided capture UX — no deferral possible

Who: 411 Insurance capture-only fails (~75/mo)

Why no defer: Liability document — must clear before first ride

Retry rates: 67.4% → 73.8% → 76.4% pass on own retry

Central case: ~46–52/month additional approved

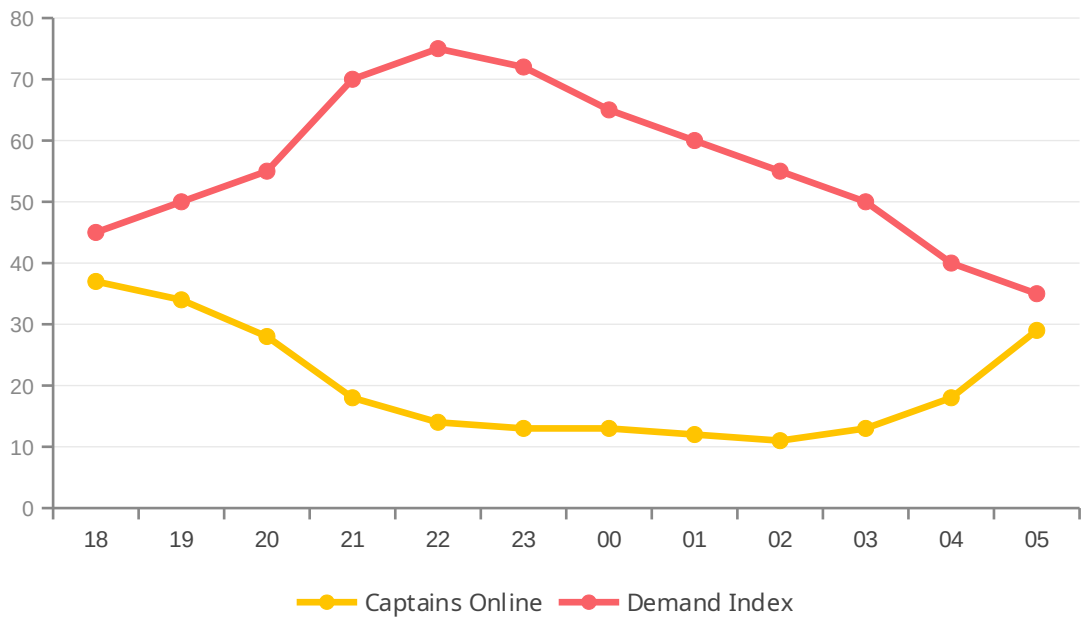
Needs: Engineering UX only — no sign-off required

Ship C1b this week. Start Legal scoping on C1a in parallel. Same camera UX can reuse on DL / Aadhaar / Permit / Fitness — not added to 180.

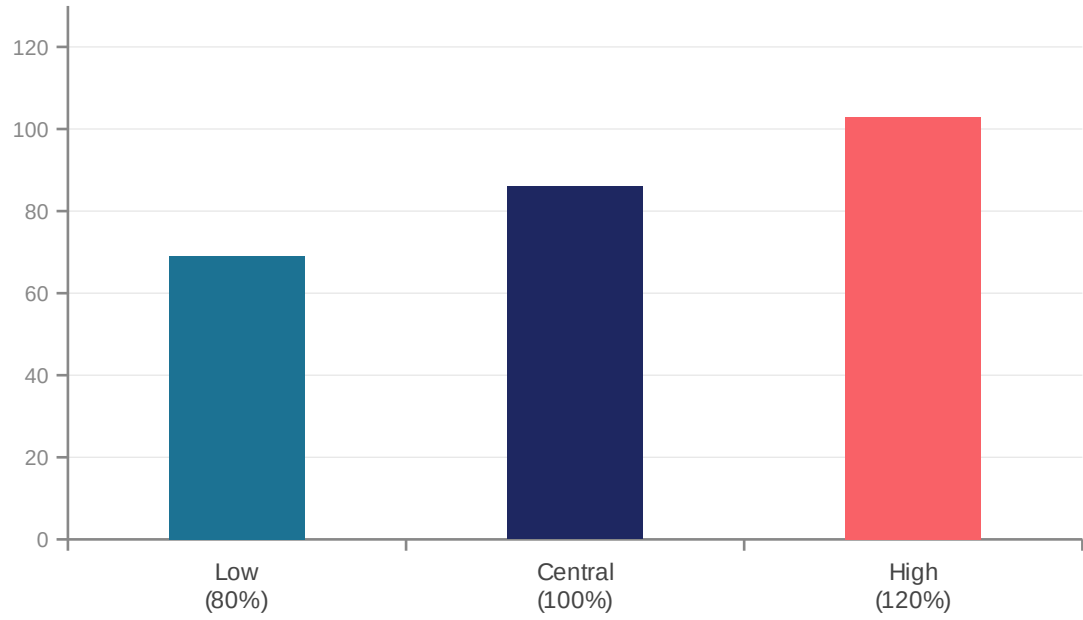


Overnight airport is a compounding economics problem, not a headcount problem

Captains online vs demand index by hour (18:00–05:00)



ARA monthly payout estimate (₹k/month) at ₹35.4/leg



40%

airport demand unfulfilled vs ~3% elsewhere

84%

of night gap sits in 21:00–03:59 — only ~13 captains vs ~37 by day

₹35.4

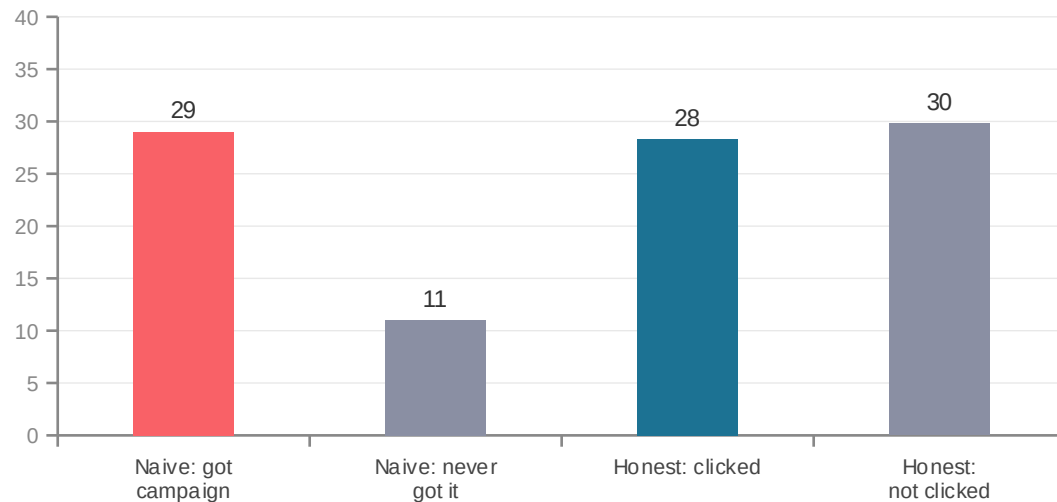
per eligible leg = derived ARA payout (not 30% of fare = ₹105)

A campaign with 0pp lift, and a gap we must not bank

CAMP_WA_002 — WhatsApp campaign



The 29% vs 11% headline is targeting, not effect.



Honest comparison: clicked vs not-clicked (delivered only) = -1.5pp ; 95% CI $[-3.6, +0.6]$. That is 0pp lift. Do not fund 5x.

~30% of recipients also got another campaign — confounding further inflated.

Field vs. self-serve gap — do not double-count



- Mechanical ceiling if app/paid converted like field: 128–256 additional/month
- But field teams recruit in person — extract cannot separate who they recruit from how they onboard
- 726 of the C1a RC group are the same self-serve captains this gap already counts — do not add $180 + 128\text{--}256$
- Fos abandonment after Fitness: 26% vs paid 43% — in-person assist, not WhatsApp
- Correct move: Randomised assisted-onboarding pilot on app/paid signups (~900 per arm to detect a 5pp lift)

Correct move: Send/no-send RCT on RC-cleared self-serve captains, excl. overlap. **Randomised assisted-onboarding pilot** on app/paid signups (~900/arm to detect a 5pp lift).

RECOMMENDATIONS & DECISION POINTS

Ranked by monthly impact. The campaign call is the fastest yes.

	ACTION	MONTHLY IMPACT	COST / RISK	WATCH
	1 C1a: 10-day RC in-person grace window C1b: Insurance upload UX (ship this week)	~180/mo approved	C1a: Legal + T&S sign-off C1b: engineering only, no sign-off	Approved split by cohort
	2 Airport Return Assurance at ₹35.4/leg (derived payout — not 30% of fare)	₹69k-103k/mo payout; night gap closed	Sampled trips ≠ city P&L. Rest-suburban only.	Return-in-20min, cancel rate, 4-wk payout run-rate
	3 Stop CAMP_WA_002 5× scaling; run send/no-send RCT on RC-cleared self-serve captains	Cost avoided + causal answer in 4-6 weeks	Near zero — a redirection, not new spend	Aadhaar-pass, approved (ITT)

Ask of the room: (1) Ship Insurance capture UX — no need to wait. (2) Legal scoping on RC deferral, this week. (3) Kill the 5× WhatsApp paper; stand up the RCT. (4) Four-week ARA pilot at the derived ₹35.4, not 30% of fare.